

Govt approves electronics development fund

To boost local manufacturing, the Cabinet has approved communications ministry's policy to set up an electronics development fund (EDF), which will invest in electronics and information technology (IT) entrepreneurial ventures.

The policy frame for the EDF is aimed at resolving unavailability of adequate risk capital through venture funds for research and development, innovation and intellectual property creation in the companies operating in four areas—electronic system and design, manufacturing, nano-electronics and IT.

The corpus of the fund, which has been left open-ended, will be managed by Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) or similar financial institution to fund start-ups and other ventures that promote EDF policy.

A national policy on electronics had anticipated that EDF will be a fund-of-funds to participate in daughter-of-funds (angel funds and venture funds). The plan is to leverage these funds to acquire foreign companies, so as to shift the manufacturing of products currently imported in large volumes into the country.

The current domestic demand for electronics in India is about US\$ 45 billion and is expected to grow at a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 22 per cent up to 2020, according to the government's department of electronics. As per the current growth rate, the production of electronics hardware in the country is likely to grow to US\$ 42 billion by the end of 2014 and US\$ 105 billion by 2020.

MNRE announces duty exemption for roof-top solar projects

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy has announced excise duty exemption certificates (EDECs) with immediate effect for solar power developers setting-up off-grid solar

Chairman Wu and Mrs Wu step down from CRS Electronics board of directors

CRS Electronics Inc. announced the resignation of Chang Jiang Wu and Lian Wu from the board of directors. The company is a leader in the emerging, rapidly-growing market of high-efficiency LEDs.

Samsung has restructured leadership team in India

BD Park has been appointed as global business head of Samsung and is relocating to headquarters in Korea after six years in India. While in the country, he was managing director of Samsung India and president of South West Asia operations, and he made the Korean firm the country's largest consumer electronics and smartphone maker with more than ₹ 400 billion revenue.

In Focus

HyunChil Hong, president, Samsung Electronics Latin America, is going to take over as the new president of Southwest Asia regional headquarters, where he will become the new MD of Samsung India.

Samsung has appointed Indian engineer Pranav Mistry as vice president of global operations. He was earlier the vice president of R&D and head of think-tank team based in the USA.

Rajiv Mishra has been appointed as head of corporate social responsibility division in India, adding to his current role of vice president of internal and external communications.

At the same time, Samsung India's deputy MD Ravinder Zutshi is retiring from the company. He has been one of the first employees of Samsung India and was recently heading government relations for the firm in India.

photovoltaic power projects for all roof-top solar projects with a minimum capacity of 100kW.

This is expected to reduce the overall cost of the project, while making solar panels cheaper for end-users. MNRE stated that, in order to meet the demand of off-grid projects, they have developed a satisfactory manufacturing capacity in the domestic market and will also issue EDECs to encourage domestic manufacturing.

IIT Kanpur installs first roof-top solar plant

IIT Kanpur has installed its first roof-top solar plant at its campus. The 50kW plant was inaugurated last year, after which efforts to strengthen it were made.

The installed plant has a capacity of 344kW

(kilowatts peak). Prof. RS Anand said that in phase I, the solar power plant has been established on roof-tops with the breakdown as follows: western lab (212.45kWp), western lab extension (28kWp), faculty building (80.08kWp) and northern lab II (24kWp).

He stated that this power PV plant has a mix of high-efficiency and normal-efficiency silicon modules based technologies. The total cost of the installed 344kWp solar PV plants is close to ₹ 30 million. Prof. Anand mentioned that in the second phase over 1400kWp roof-top solar plants



Roof-top solar